GIFT

GRANTS INDEX FOR TEXAS · METHODOLOGY · TAX YEAR 2023

GIFT Methodology

GIFT, Grants Index For Texas. Texas foundation giving, opened up, so your next funder is a search away.

Status: v0.6, current. See amendment log at the end for revision history.

This document has two parts. The Public Version explains GIFT in plain language for any reader. The Technical Version documents the full pipeline, sources, and rules for anyone who wants to audit or rebuild the index.

Public Version

What GIFT is

GIFT, Grants Index For Texas, exists to help Texas nonprofits find funders they can actually approach. It is built entirely from public IRS data, the annual returns that grantmaking organizations file, and it focuses on a single tax year, currently 2023, so every funder is measured on the same footing.

GIFT covers two kinds of funder, private foundations and grantmaking public charities. They are ranked separately because they file different returns and operate differently, and the top funders are shown on each side.

What it takes to be included

An organization is included when it is a real, approachable grantmaker. In plain terms that means four things.

It is reachable. Its money goes to outside organizations rather than only to itself or a single affiliate.

It chooses. It decides its own giving rather than passing predetermined money straight through.

It gives cash. Real grant dollars a nonprofit can use, not donated goods or services.

It is identifiable. It has a public identity you can research and contact.

For private foundations, which give by law and choose their grantees by design, those qualities come with the territory, so the only real question is reachability, whether the foundation funds beyond its own walls. For public charities, which are a mix of true funders and organizations that mostly run their own programs, the test does more work, and organizations that move money but cannot be approached are left out so the list stays useful.

What gets left out, and why

It is worth being specific about what gets left out, because some of these organizations move a great deal of money and a reader might reasonably wonder where they went. There are five reasons GIFT sets an organization aside.

A closed loop. The organization gives only to the parent it was created to serve, so the money never reaches the wider nonprofit world. For example, a university's own foundation that funds only its university, or a senior living company's charitable arm that supports only its own residents.

Running programs rather than making grants. The money is the organization's own operating budget. For example, a museum that funds its own exhibits, or a service that passes a donor's gift straight through to a recipient the donor already chose.

A closed network. The recipients are a fixed, certified membership that an outside nonprofit cannot join, so the money moves but a newcomer cannot get in. For example, the statewide network of certified court advocates.

Goods instead of cash. The organization distributes donated food or supplies rather than grant dollars a nonprofit can spend. This includes programs that pass federal nutrition funding to enrolled childcare providers, which are both a closed network and an in kind program at once.

No public identity. The organization cannot be found, verified, or contacted at all.

In the current public charity list, 40 organizations were set aside for one or more of these reasons, each recorded openly in a published audit file so anyone can check the call.

What each funder entry shows

For each funder, GIFT shows where the money went, the organizations it granted to and how much. Grants of $5,000 or more are shown, which is the IRS statutory minimum for itemized grant reporting on Schedule I and Part XV of the respective returns. This recipient detail is available for most funders. For some it is not, because the funder reported its grants as a separate attachment, as a single lump sum, or as donated goods rather than as an itemized list. In those cases the funder still appears with its total giving, marked to show that a recipient breakdown was not available in its filing.

Where a foundation's filing states that it gives only to organizations it has already chosen and does not take unsolicited requests, GIFT notes that, so a nonprofit knows not to spend effort applying where the door is not open. Where the filing does not say, GIFT leaves it unmarked rather than guess, since a silent filing is not the same as a closed one.

Where the organization reported a website address or mission statement in its filing, GIFT displays those as well. Two funders in the private foundation set have no 2023 electronic filing available in the public index; they appear in the ranked list with their total giving only, and their profiles note the absence.

What each recipient entry shows

For each recipient, GIFT shows which indexed funders supported it, how much each gave, and what the grant was for. This lets a grantseeker see the full picture of who funds organizations like theirs.

Where the recipient filed a Form 990 electronically for tax year 2023, GIFT also shows the recipient's own reported total of contributions and grants from all sources. This figure is from the recipient's own filing and covers all giving it received globally, not only from indexed Texas funders. Alongside it, GIFT shows the sum of indexed Texas grants and an approximate remainder representing everything else: smaller grants, funders outside the index, out-of-state funders, and individual giving combined. The remainder is approximate because funder grants and the recipient total may cover slightly different reporting periods.

Where available from filings, GIFT also shows each recipient's website address, mission statement, and NTEE classification code.

Where the data comes from

Everything here comes from public records, reflects filings that run roughly a year behind, and is free to use. The data comes from the grantmaking returns that organizations file with the IRS, gathered from the IRS itself and from the GivingTuesday 990 Data Lake, an open archive of those filings. NTEE classification codes come from the IRS national Business Master File. The index was built with open tools, the Python programming language, with Claude, an AI assistant, used to help write and check the code.

Who makes GIFT

GIFT is made by Jonathan Lin Davis as an independent public good. It is free to use, it takes no money, and it endorses no one. Figures run about a year behind the present and are refreshed quarterly.

Technical Version

GIFT methodology, full pipeline. Created and maintained by Jonathan Lin Davis, an independent public good. Authorship and licensing appear at the end of this part.

The technical version is organized in four parts. Part A defines what GIFT measures and the scope rules. Part B documents the inclusion standard and the exclusions it produced. Part C describes the attributes each funder and recipient entry carries. Part D records sources, methods, freshness, and licensing.

Part A, what GIFT measures

A1. Purpose and unit

GIFT indexes Texas grantmaking organizations to help nonprofits identify reachable funders. The unit of ranking is the organization, measured by grants paid in a single tax year, currently tax year 2023, selected because it is the most recent year with complete filing coverage in the source data.

A2. Two populations, ranked separately

GIFT ranks two filer types separately. Private foundations, which file Form 990-PF, and grantmaking public charities, which file Form 990. They are kept on separate lists because the forms report grants differently and the two types operate differently in law and practice.

A3. Texas scope

An organization is included if its Business Master File state is Texas, reconciled against its mailing address, which both keeps genuine Texas filers and catches mailing artifacts.

A4. Grant size floor

Recipient level grants are reported at $5,000 and above. The floor matches the IRS statutory minimum for itemized grant reporting on Schedule I (Form 990, line 2) and Part XV (Form 990-PF); grants below that threshold are not required to be listed by recipient in the public filing.

A5. Cutoff

Each side publishes its top 100 by grants paid.

Part B, the inclusion standard

B1. The four principles

An organization is included only if it is reachable, discretionary, a cash grantmaker, and identifiable.

Reachability. Its giving flows to outside organizations rather than to itself or a single affiliate.

Discretion. It exercises ongoing choice over its giving rather than passing predetermined funds through.

Cash. It makes monetary grants rather than in kind contributions.

Identifiability. It has a distinct public identity that can be researched and contacted.

B2. How the principles apply by filer type

Private foundations. Because a 990-PF filer is by law a grantmaker that chooses grantees, discretion, cash, and transparency are satisfied by the filing type and require no per name screening. Reachability is the only active screen. It excludes a foundation only when its giving forms a closed loop, flowing entirely or predominantly to a parent or commonly controlled entity it exists to serve, such that the funds do not reach the independent nonprofit sector. The number of recipients a foundation funds does not bear on this, a foundation that gives to a single outside organization is reachable, and a corporate foundation is excluded only when it funds solely its own parent rather than merely because it carries a company name. Invitation only giving is not disqualifying, the door existing but being harder to open is still a door.

Public charities. Because 990 filers mix genuine funders with operators and pass throughs, all four principles are actively screened.

B3. Public charity exclusions, by basis

In the published set, 40 organizations that would otherwise rank by grant volume are excluded, each for a documented reason recorded in the exclusion audit file. The bases, with counts by every principle an organization fails, are as follows. Because six organizations fail on two bases each and are listed under both, the basis figures total 46 and reconcile to 40 distinct organizations.

Closed loop to a controlled entity, the reachability failure, 15 organizations. The funder's giving flows entirely or predominantly to a parent or commonly controlled entity it exists to serve, so the money does not reach the independent nonprofit sector. Examples, the Texas A&M Foundation, which funds its own university system, and the Lifespace Foundation, which serves only the residents and staff of its parent senior living company. One of these, Trinity Christian Academy, also fails the cash principle.

Operators and conduits, the discretion failure, 9 organizations. Operators run their own programs, so the dollars are program expenses rather than grants, and conduits pass money through without exercising choice over recipients. Examples, the USS Lexington museum association, which operates its own museum, and DonateStock Charitable, a stock donation processor that routes proceeds to recipients the donor designates.

Closed certified or membership networks, 10 organizations. The recipients form a fixed, certified, or enrolled set that an outside organization cannot join, so even though money reaches multiple recipients, a grantseeker structurally cannot become one. Examples, Texas CASA and the Childrens Advocacy Centers of Texas, certified chapter networks. Five of the ten are USDA federal nutrition reimbursement programs that also fail the cash principle, noted under the next basis.

In kind rather than cash, 9 organizations. The organization distributes goods or services rather than grant dollars a nonprofit can spend. Examples, Trusted World, which distributes donated goods. Five of the nine are USDA Child and Adult Care Food Program reimbursement programs, such as Feeding

Texas, that move federal nutrition dollars to enrolled providers, and these also fail the closed network principle. One, Trinity Christian Academy, also fails reachability.

No researchable public identity, the transparency failure, 3 organizations. The entity has no findable mission, leadership, or activity, or its filing identity does not match any researchable organization, so it cannot be verified or approached.

The complete list of excluded organizations, each with its EIN and documented basis, is published in the exclusion audit file that accompanies the index.

Part C, what each funder and recipient carries

C1. Application posture, displayed not filtered

Each funder carries an application posture field with two states, does not accept unsolicited requests, or unstated, derived from the 990-PF filing. The field is read from a single checkbox in which a foundation declares that it makes contributions only to preselected organizations and does not accept unsolicited requests. This box is one directional in the source data, it is either checked, which is recorded as does not accept unsolicited requests, or absent, which is recorded as unstated. The filing carries no affirmative marker for accepting applications, because acceptance is represented by the absence of the box, which cannot be distinguished from a foundation that simply did not complete this part of the return. For this reason the field never asserts that a foundation accepts applications, it states only what the filing affirmatively declares. Unstated never implies closed, a blank is not a refusal. The field is informational only and never used to include or exclude, and it is reported as filed for the tax year, not as current live guidance. In the current private foundation set, 52 funders are marked does not accept unsolicited requests and 48 are unstated.

C2. Recipient coverage and its limits

Recipient detail is extracted from each funder's return and is available for the large majority of funders. Two private foundations in the indexed set have no 2023 electronic filing available in the public index and are excluded from the parsing universe. Of the remaining 198 funders, recipient level detail was successfully parsed for 177, 89 percent. Where recipient detail is not available, it is because the funder reported grants in one of three ways the structured filing does not itemize: as a separate attachment or schedule rather than in the return data, as a single lump sum total, or as noncash assistance such as donated goods rather than cash grants. Funders in this situation still appear in the index with their total giving and are marked to show that a recipient breakdown was not available in the filing. This is a limitation of how those organizations chose to file, not of the index, and the coverage marking makes it visible per funder rather than hidden.

C3. Deduplication and entity handling

Filings are selected to prefer the grant-bearing return when an organization filed more than one form in the year. Funders appearing under more than one EIN are resolved individually, the flagship entity retained and brand sharing supporting organizations judged on their own identity and reachability.

C4. Recipient resolution

The index is browsable in two directions, from a funder to the organizations it granted to, and from a recipient to the funders that supported it. Building the recipient direction requires deciding when two grant records name the same organization. Recipient grants carry an EIN in about half of cases, so resolution uses the EIN as the trustworthy key where present, and where it is absent uses a deterministic normalization of the recipient name combined with state. Normalization is rule based and reproducible, it uppercases, removes punctuation, standardizes common abbreviations, strips legal suffixes, removes a leading article, and drops a trailing city token that duplicates the city field. Two records merge only on an exact match after normalization, or when a name only record matches the normalized name and state of an EIN bearing record. No similarity scoring or fuzzy matching is used, because falsely combining two distinct organizations would misrepresent who funds whom, which is the central question the index answers. The method therefore under merges rather than over merges, a recipient may occasionally appear under more than one entry, but every funding relationship shown is one the filings actually report. Where the source filings themselves report different organizations under a shared EIN, the index reflects the filings as reported rather than overriding them.

Grant records carrying a placeholder in place of a recipient name, such as a reference to a separate attachment or schedule, are handled at the funder level. When a funder's filing returns only a single such row, the entire funder is classified as detail unavailable and excluded from the recipient edge file. The affected funders retain their total giving in the index and are marked accordingly.

From 21,384 grant records at $5,000 or above, the resolution process produces 12,890 distinct recipients, 7,728 keyed by EIN and 5,162 by normalized name and state.

C5. Funder and recipient metadata

Each funder and recipient entry carries a website address, mission statement, and NTEE classification code where these are available.

Website address and mission statement are extracted from each organization's electronic filing XML. For website, the tag WebsiteAddressTxt is read from the return root. Values that are blank, explicitly filed as "N/A" or "NONE", or contain only a bare protocol string are treated as not provided and suppressed. For mission, three tags are read in priority order: MissionDesc, ActivityOrMissionDesc, and PrimaryExemptPurposeTxt. The first non-blank value of at least 50 characters is used. Mission text is capped at 800 characters in the stored record; the display layer truncates further and provides an expand option.

NTEE classification codes are sourced from the IRS national Business Master File, combining the four regional files distributed by the IRS. The NTEE code is the field NTEE_CD from that file; the major category is derived from the leading letter per the standard NTEE taxonomy (A through Z).

Coverage at current run. Funders: 135 of 200 carry a website after suppressing filed non-values; 97 of 200 carry a mission. The raw XML extraction returned 189 website values, of which 54 were filed as "N/A" or equivalent and were suppressed. Recipients: of 12,890 recipients, 4,741 have an electronic filing in the index, of which 4,029 carry a website and 4,268 carry a mission. NTEE codes from the national BMF cover 5,723 of 12,890 recipients.

C6. Recipient-side totals

Where a recipient filed a Form 990 electronically for tax year 2023, GIFT displays the recipient's own reported total of contributions and grants alongside the indexed giving. The source is Form 990, Part VIII, Statement of Revenue, line 1h (total contributions, gifts, grants, and similar amounts received), column A (total). This figure is from the recipient's own filing and represents all contributions received from all sources globally, not only from indexed Texas funders.

The recipient page displays three lines: the recipient's own total contributions from its Form 990 (the headline figure); the sum of indexed Texas grants of $5,000 or above reported by the indexed funders for tax year 2023 (already in the index); and an approximate remainder, computed as the first minus the second. The remainder is one undifferentiated bucket and is not broken down further. It covers smaller grants, funders outside the index, out-of-state funders, and individual giving combined. Individual giving cannot be isolated because Schedule B (donor lists) is redacted on public 501(c)(3) filings.

The remainder is labeled approximate and is not an exact reconciliation. Funder grants are reported by funders for tax year 2023 as filed. The recipient total is from the recipient's own fiscal year filing, selected on the same TaxYear 2023 index basis, which for a June fiscal year funder means the filing for the year ending mid-2024. The two figures therefore may cover slightly different periods.

The recipient total is retrieved from the electronic XML filing using the same GivingTuesday Data Lake index used for the funder pull, filtered to TaxYear 2023. The tag read is the Part VIII line 1h column A amount. Where the tag is absent due to schema variation across filing years, a logged second pass attempts alternate tag forms. Where a total cannot be resolved, or where the recipient has no electronic filing in the index, the total section is hidden on the recipient profile and only the indexed grants are shown.

Coverage: 4,669 of 12,890 recipients display a recipient total. Only EIN-keyed recipients can be matched to a filing; the 5,162 name-keyed recipients never show a total.

C7. Funders with no 2023 electronic filing

Two private foundations in the indexed set, Salesmanship Club of Dallas (EIN 750717135) and Salesmanship Club Foundation (EIN 752439715), have no 2023 filing available in the public electronic index at the time of this run. Both appear in the private foundation ranked list with their grants paid figure drawn from the IRS Statistics of Income extract, which provides the ranking financials for all indexed funders. Neither carries recipient detail, website, mission, or application posture derived from an XML filing. Each funder profile displays a notice that no 2023 electronic filing is available in the public index. These funders are excluded from the parsing universe for the purposes of C2 coverage figures.

Part D, sources, methods, and terms

D1. Data sources

IRS Exempt Organizations Business Master File, Texas extract. The organization universe, names, classification codes, and Texas scope. File eo_tx.csv, retrieved from https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-soi/eo_tx.csv.

IRS Exempt Organizations Business Master File, national extract. NTEE classification codes for funders and recipients. Combined from four regional files eo1.csv through eo4.csv, each retrieved from https://www.irs.gov/pub/irs-soi/ and deduplicated by EIN. The national file covers 1,974,830 organizations; NTEE codes are populated for approximately 71 percent.

IRS Statistics of Income annual extracts. The ranking financials, grants paid and total functional expenses, from the processing year file predominantly composed of tax year 2023 returns. The 990 and 990-PF extract files, retrieved from the IRS Statistics of Income downloads at https://www.irs.gov/statistics/soi-tax-stats-annual-extract-of-tax-exempt-organization-financial-data.

GivingTuesday 990 Data Lake. The electronically filed Form 990 series return XML used for funder recipient level grants, funder and recipient website and mission metadata, and recipient-side total contributions. Accessed through the Data Lake index of filings and the individual return XML it points to, hosted in public Amazon Web Services S3 storage and retrieved anonymously. The index file used is a fixed snapshot keyed to the date of retrieval, ensuring that funder and recipient pulls reference the same filing universe.

D2. Validation

ProPublica Nonprofit Explorer and comparable public records were used to spot check individual organizations during the inclusion review, confirming identity, affiliation, and grantmaking behavior in borderline cases. These were a verification aid during construction, not a data source for the index, and no ProPublica data is incorporated into the published files.

D3. Tools, and how each was used

Python, the programming language for the whole pipeline. Its standard library read the IRS comma separated value extracts, reconciled the Texas universe, applied the inclusion screens, ranked each side by grants paid, parsed the return XML for funder recipient level grants and for funder and recipient website and mission metadata, and parsed recipient return XML for Part VIII line 1h totals. The parser handles the IRS electronic filing namespace and branches by form type, the 990-PF grants paid schedule for foundations and Schedule I for public charities.

A local command line terminal running Windows 11 and PowerShell, with Python 3.14, where every data run was executed against locally downloaded copies of the source files, so each step was reproducible and inspected before moving on.

Claude, an AI assistant from Anthropic, used during development to help write, diagnose, and verify the analysis and parser code, including identifying field mappings, schema variation across filing years, and data quality cases such as attachment only and noncash filings. All production runs were executed and reviewed by the author.

Formats handled. IRS comma separated value extracts for the organization, financial, and BMF layers; IRS Form 990 series XML for funder recipient detail, funder metadata, recipient metadata, and recipient-side totals; output written as comma separated value files and JSON for the index.

D4. Freshness and refresh

Filings run roughly a year behind, so the current index reflects tax year 2023. The index is refreshed manually on a quarterly basis, with each refresh reviewed before publication.

D5. Authorship, independence, and licensing

GIFT is created and maintained by Jonathan Lin Davis. It is an independent public good, built and published in a personal capacity, and is not affiliated with, sponsored by, or endorsed by any agency, foundation, funder, or campaign. GIFT makes no endorsements of any organization it lists, inclusion reflects only the objective standard described above and never a judgment of merit. The underlying data is released under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 license, and the code under the MIT license, so the work can be freely reused, audited, and rebuilt by anyone.

Amendment log

- v0.1 draft. Wording locked across both versions. Open items: fill the public charity exclusion list and count, fill recipient coverage figures, both from the full top 100 per side run, then verify every clause against the actual output before marking final.
- v0.2. Full top 100 per side run complete. Private foundation principle rewritten from the retired single beneficiary framing to the locked reachability standard, closed loop to a controlled entity, with recipient count explicitly not bearing on inclusion and invitation only giving not disqualifying. Public charity exclusions filled, 40 distinct organizations excluded, presented by the five bases with counts by every principle an organization fails, six organizations failing two bases each shown under both, basis figures totaling 46 reconciling to 40 distinct. Public version expanded to walk through the five exclusion bases in plain language with an example of each. Recipient coverage filled, 171 of 195 funders parsed with recipient detail, 88 percent. Per category counts verified against the exclusion list before drafting. Private foundation side carries zero exclusions under the reachability standard. Full named exclusion roster with individual reasons maintained in the accompanying exclusion audit file.
- v0.3. Application posture extracted from the 100 private foundation filings. The 990-PF marks only the preselected case, a single checkbox present as a checkmark or absent, with no affirmative marker for accepting applications. Posture narrowed from three states to two honest states, does not accept unsolicited requests and unstated, because acceptance cannot be

distinguished from a blank filing. Public version posture sentence aligned to mark only the closed door and leave silent filings unmarked. Distribution: 52 of 100 funders marked does not accept unsolicited requests, 48 unstated. Posture written as a column on the private foundation list.

- v0.4. Document reorganized for readability. Public version broken into six scannable sections with headers. Technical version grouped into four lettered parts, Part A what GIFT measures, Part B the inclusion standard, Part C what each funder carries, Part D sources methods and terms, with scope rules consolidated in Part A. Wording preserved with light polish only, no rules changed.
- v0.5. Two directional views built from the recipient grant edges, funder to recipients and recipient to funders, plus a recipient summary. Recipient resolution documented in new section C4, EIN first then deterministic name and state normalization, no fuzzy matching, conservative under merge. From 16,950 edges at $10,000 floor, 7 filing placeholder rows removed, resolving to 10,259 distinct recipients, 6,160 keyed by EIN. Section C4 also documents placeholder handling and the treatment of organizations that share an EIN in source filings.
- v0.6. Grant floor lowered from $10,000 to $5,000, matching the IRS statutory minimum for itemized grant reporting on Schedule I (Form 990) and Part XV (Form 990-PF); A4 updated with statutory basis. Edge and recipient counts updated to reflect the new floor: 21,384 grant records, 12,890 distinct recipients, 7,728 keyed by EIN, 5,162 by normalized name and state. Recipient coverage updated: parsing universe is 198 of 200 funders (2 have no 2023 electronic filing), 177 of 198 parsed with recipient detail, 89 percent; C2 revised. Two no-filing funders documented in new section C7 (Salesmanship Club of Dallas, EIN 750717135; Salesmanship Club Foundation, EIN 752439715). Funder and recipient metadata added in new section C5: website from WebsiteAddressTxt, mission from MissionDesc / ActivityOrMissionDesc / PrimaryExemptPurposeTxt, NTEE code from IRS national BMF; coverage figures stated. Recipient-side totals added in new section C6: Form 990 Part VIII line 1h column A, three-line display (recipient total, indexed grants, approximate remainder), approximate-remainder caveat stated, coverage 4,669 of 12,890 recipients. Part C title updated to reflect that recipients now also carry documented attributes. D1 updated with national BMF as a named data source and GivingTuesday Data Lake entry expanded to cover recipient XML pulls. D3 updated to reflect recipient XML parsing and expanded format list. Public version updated: A4 floor change reflected in grant description; new section added for what each recipient entry shows, covering indexed funders, recipient total, approximate remainder, and metadata fields.